ever to consider turning over the Vale of Kashmir to Pakistan. India's Hindu High Commissioner to Pakistan, Sri Prakasha, once had the temerity to suggest to Mountbatten that the "wisest" thing India could do in Kashmir was to "let Pakistan have it," but Nehru angrily vetoed that proposal.

In March 1951, the Security Council adopted a new resolution on Jammu and Kashmir, and Dr. Frank Graham, former North Carolina senator and later president of the University of North Carolina, flew to South Asia as the last nominee sent out to administer a UN plebiscite there. Graham found Nehru unresponsive to his numerous appeals and proposals. That July, Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan of Pakistan informed British Commonwealth colleagues that heavy fire had been exchanged across the Kashmir cease-fire line, along which nine-tenths of India's army was deployed. India countered by charging Pakistan with sending armed terrorists over the line and encouraging them to wage jihad. After both countries brought up more troops and moved heavy artillery closer to the line, Liaquat agreed to meet with Nehru in New Delhi to seek some formula to settle their dispute over Kashmir. Shortly before the date scheduled for their New Delhi summit meeting, however, Liaquat was assassinated at Pakistan's army headquarters in Rawalpindi on 16 October 1951. He had just begun to address his officer corps, urging patience in dealing with India, when shots silenced him. Liaquat's Afghan assassin was instantly shot dead by an officer inside that stadium. No investigation ever led to punishment of the killers who had conspired to murder Pakistan's first prime minister.

Since Liaquat's assassination, Pakistan's army has remained the most powerful institution of Pakistan's polity. "Most nations have an army," Nehru once said, "but Pakistan's army has a nation." Jinnah's popular Muslim League Party had initially trained a cadre of civil administrators to run Pakistan. However, after Pakistan's army emerged from the command of British colonels and generals, it swiftly usurped power from Pakistan's political leaders and civil bureaucrats. Punjabi and Pathan generals have since 1951 ruled virtually unchallenged from their headquarters in Rawalpindi. Pakistan's generals have always believed that India was merely playing for time by agreeing to hold a plebiscite. They felt certain that Nehru would never surrender Kashmir, no matter how large a majority of its Muslims might vote for Pakistan. Liaquat was considered too weak to fight for Kashmir's Muslims, as Jinnah had so forcefully done. Nor did the army have any faith in East Pakistan's Bengali politicians, who cared little about distant Kashmir. India soon